

missing at least two key ingredients: specifics and a deadline. To make your goal SMART, you need to hit all five points by writing something like, “I want to pay off my house in eight years by sending an additional \$500 per month toward the principal balance.” That goal tells you what you’re going to do, when you’re going to do it, and how you’re going to do it. That’s a great goal—and, incidentally, it’s one I’m going to challenge you to set for yourself a little later in this chapter.